

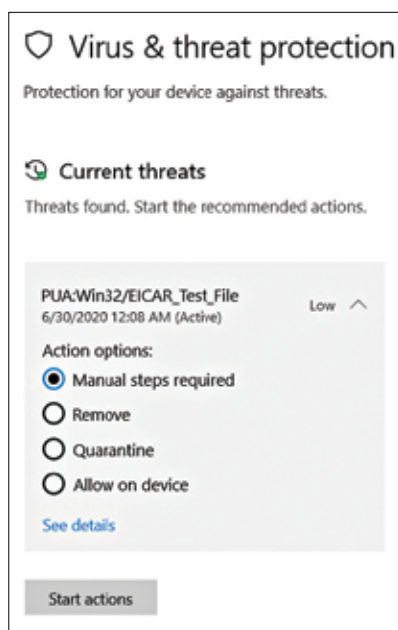
CHOOSE SIGN IN METHOD

Windows has now replaced the default sign in option with a pin number instead of a password. If you want to go back to using the password, go to **Settings > Accounts > Sign-in options**, and pick the password option. From here, it is also possible to choose a USB security key, a paired device and face recognition. There is also a biometric sign in option included in the OS, provided you have a supported fingerprint scanner attached to the machine. The Dynamic Lock option allows you to automatically lock or unlock the device when a paired smartphone comes within range.

Windows 10 also supports a rather unique method of signing into your PC – Picture passwords. To enable this, head over to Settings and then go to Accounts. Now, click on Sign-in options on the left-hand-side and then click on **Picture Password**. Press Add and enter your PIN or password in the pop-up window that shows up. Next, click on Select Picture and open the one you want to set up as your Picture Password. Click on Use this picture. Next, draw three gestures on the image and remember the sequence and position of the gestures. Windows will ask you to redraw the three gestures once again to confirm. After this, click on Finish. Now, on your sign-in screen, you'll see the image you've set up. Draw your gestures in the correct order and you'll be signed in right away!

BLOCK UNWANTED APPS

Windows Defender does a good job of protecting your computer from outright malware, such as viruses or trojan horses that may attempt to steal your credentials, or hold your data for ransom. However, there are some apps that are not outright malware, but at the same time are not apps that work entirely for the user. Apps that show ads, as well as cryptominers are in this category and are called potentially unwanted apps or PUA by Microsoft. Windows now has a setting that lets you treat the problematic apps as malware, with the same kinds of systems in place to block, quarantine and remove the apps. While using the Edge browser, the detection happens even



before you install the app. To turn on the setting, go to **Settings > Update and Security > Windows Security > App & browser control**. Here make sure that all the options for **Check apps and files**, as well as **SmartScreen** are set to either **warn** or **block**, and that none are set to **off**.

USE KAOMOJI IN TEXT

Windows has made it easy to incorporate emoji, kaomoji as well as special symbols while typing, anywhere on the system. This works across apps and the web, and allows you to insert the emoji wherever a cursor appears across the operating system, as long as the target app or website supports the input. To bring up the special characters keyboard, just press the **Windows key + . (period)**. From here, there are three tabbed panels for emoji, kaomoji



and the special characters. Users can scroll through them and select the items with the cursor. This is a great shortcut to use if you find yourself struggling to remember the alt codes for the more obscure characters.

PIN CALCULATOR

If you are using a browser combined with software and need to make a lot of calculations on the fly by going between them, then it can be problematic and time consuming to keep alt tabbing to the calculator app over and over again. To fix this problem, users are now given the option to pin the calculator to the top layer while working with numbers. Simply press **Alt + Up Arrow** to do this. It minimises the layout and pins the calculator, but do note that the history of the calculations is not available in this view. At present, the option is only available for the standard calculator, and unfortunately not for the date calculator.

USE MULTIPLE DESKTOPS

This is an old feature that most people simply do not use. Instead of managing multiple open apps and tabs in a single window, you can just designate multiple windows for say work and leisure, and quickly switch between entire desktops to bring up that particular set of apps. For example, you might want to have Spotify, Discord and WhatsApp Web on one desktop, while Photoshop, MS Office and your email sits on another desktop. To create a new desktop, click **Windows + D**. Instead of **Alt + Tab**, use **Windows + Tab** to scroll through multiple tasks on a single desktop. This view also allows you to switch between multiple desktops. By default, these have names such as Desktop A, Desktop B and so on, but for easy identification, you can click on the labels to change the names, to something like Work and Play. The emoji keyboard can be used in these desktop names. You can have as many desktops as your specifications can manage. You can also close entire desktops at once, by clicking on the cross icon next to them. Note that this will not close the apps running within that desktop, and instead just move